Hikaru Kawarazaki

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University College London

Placement Director: Professor Attila Lindner a.lindner@ucl.ac.uk
Graduate Administrator: Daniella Harper daniella.harper@ucl.ac.uk

References

Professor **Imran Rasul**
Department of Economics
University College London
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Professor **Áureo de Paula**
Department of Economics
University College London
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Professor **Monica Costa-Dias**
School of Economics
University of Bristol
monica.costa-dias@bristol.ac.uk

Professor **Emily Owens**
Department of Criminology, Law, and Society
University of California, Irvine
egowens@uci.edu

Education and Academic Appointments

Institute for Fiscal Studies — London, UK
Postdoctoral Fellow — 2025 –current

University College London — London, UK
PhD in Economics — 2021 –2025

University College London — London, UK
MRes in Economics — 2020 –2021

University of Tokyo — Tokyo, Japan
M.A. Economics — 2017 –2019

University of Tokyo — Tokyo, Japan
B.A. Economics — 2013 –2017

Fields of Interest

Economics of Education, Economics of Crime, and Labor Economics

Job Market Paper

When Trouble Travels: Peer Effects of Criminal Exposure in Schools
First contact with the criminal justice system peaks in early adolescence, when children spend much of their time with peers at school. While a large literature documents that peers shape children's development and behavior, much less is known about the consequences of exposure to schoolmates with a criminal record. Using administrative data linking criminal justice and education records for nearly all students in England, I study whether and to what extent criminal behavior spreads within schools through exposure to juvenile offenders. Exploiting the plausibly exogenous timing of school transfers by students with a criminal record, I find that exposure increases a student's probability of starting a criminal career by 12.9% within four months,

with effects persisting for at least three years. Exposure also lowers educational achievement; most of this decline is accounted for by exposed students' subsequent criminal behavior. The effects vary substantially with the share of existing offenders at the destination school: in schools with few offenders, exposure sharply increases the onset of offending but not the number of crimes, whereas the reverse holds in schools with many offenders. Given this heterogeneity, a simulation shows that reassigning transfer offenders to other schools within three miles could reduce peer-induced crime by 36%. The simulation also reveals a trade-off: an assignment that minimizes total crime may increase the number of new offenders.
*[Awarded the **Best Paper Award** at the Essen Health Conference 2026 and the Applied Econometrics Conference for Young Scholars in Japan]*

Publication

Sawada, Y., Mahmud, M., Seki, M., & Kawarazaki, H. (2024). Fighting the learning crisis in developing countries: A randomized experiment of self-learning at the right level. ***Economic Development and Cultural Change***, *72*(4), 1893–1921.

Kawarazaki, H. (2023). Early childhood education and care: Effects after half a century and their mechanisms. ***Journal of Population Economics***, *36*(4), 2725–2797.

Kawarazaki, H., Mahmud, M., Sawada, Y., & Seki, M. (2023). Haste makes no waste: Positive peer effects of classroom speed competition on learning. ***Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics***, *85*(4), 755–772.

Research Papers

Prolific Juvenile Offenders
with Sarah Cattan, Monica Costa-Dias, and Imran Rasul

The Schooling System and Teen Crime: New Evidence on Gender Difference from Administrative Data from England
with Sarah Cattan, Monica Costa-Dias, and Imran Rasul

Youth Crime in the Era of School Takeovers. Evidence from London Secondary School Academies
with Emma Duchini, Stephen Machin, and Victor Lavy

Policy Reports

Fighting the learning crisis with self-learning at the right level (2026), VoxDev
with Minhaj Mahmud, Mai Seki, Yasuyuki Sawada, and Kazuma Takakura

Other Employment

International Monetary Fund — Washington, D.C., USA
Intern — 2024

Asian Development Bank — Manila, Philippines
Consultant — 2020

Asian Development Bank — Manila, Philippines
Intern — 2019

Teaching

Teaching Assistant at University College London

- Topics in Household Economics 2023–2025
  Professor: Valérie Lechene
- Quantitative Economics and Econometrics 2021–2023
  Professors: Kirill Borusyak, Dennis Kristensen, Daniel Lewis, and Áureo de Paula

Teaching Assistant at University of Tokyo

- Econometrics (Graduate) 2019–2020
  Professors: Hidehiko Ichimura and Katsumi Shimotsu
- Development Economics (Graduate) 2019
  Professor: Yasuyuki Sawada
- Econometrics (Undergraduate) 2018–2019
  Professor: Katsumi Shimotsu
- Computational Methods for Econometrics 2018–2019
  Instructor
- Math Camp 2018
  Instructor
- Development Economics (Undergraduate) 2017–2019
  Professors: Yasuyuki Sawada, Takeshi Aida, Hiroyuki Yamada
- Seminar (Development Economics) 2016–2017
  Professor: Yasuyuki Sawada

Research Grants

- The Japan Center for Economic Research (JPY 700,000) 2026–2027
- Uehiro Foundation on Ethics and Education (JPY 600,000) 2026–2027
- Shiho Kyokai (JPY 300,000) 2025–2026
- Shiho Kyokai (JPY 400,000) 2024–2025
- Uehiro Foundation on Ethics and Education (JPY 600,000) 2024–2025
- Suntory Foundation (JPY 1,000,000) 2024–2025
- Economic and Social Research Council Studentship (GBP 2,250) 2021–2024

Scholarships and Awards

- Best Paper Award at Applied Econometrics Conference for Young Scholars in Japan 2026
- Best Paper Award at Essen Health Conference 2026
- Economic and Social Research Council Studentship (MPhil/PhD) 2021–2024
- Japan-IMF Scholarship Program for Advanced Studies 2020–2022
- Japan Student Services Organization, Graduate Scholarship for Degree Seeking Students (MRes) 2020–2021
- Research Fellow (DC2), Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (JPSP) 2020
- CREPE Trainee (Scholarship Student) at Center for Research and Education in Program Evaluation (CREPE), the University of Tokyo 2017–2020

Presentations

- **2026:** National Graduate Institute for Policy Studies, Institute for Fiscal Studies, European Association of Young Economists, Centre for Economic Performance-Becker Friedman Institute for Economics at the University of Chicago Conference on the Economics of Crime and Justice, Essen Health Conference, European Society for Population Economics, Workshop on the Economics of Crime for Junior Scholars, Workshop on Labour and Family Economics, Kyoto Summer Workshop on Applied Economics, Royal Economic Society, Workshop on the Economics of Risky Behavior, European Association of Labour Economists Conference, Newcastle University, The Network Science and Economics Conference, University College London, Applied Econometrics Conference, Institute for Social and Economic Research at the University of Essex
- **2025:** Sophia University, Workshop on Education Economics and Policy, World Congress of the Econometric Society, Otaru University of Commerce, Royal Economic Society, University College London, Institute for Fiscal Studies
- **2024:** University of Tokyo, IZA/ECONtribute, International Monetary Fund, University College London, Institute for Fiscal Studies
- **2023:** University of Tokyo, Econometric Society European Winter Meeting, National Graduate Institute for Policy Studies, University College London, University of Mannheim
- **2022:** Asian and Australasian Society of Labour Economics Conference, Institute for Fiscal Studies
- **2021:** HCEO-NES-CREC Virtual Summer School on Socioeconomic Inequality, Japanese Association of Development Economics
- **2020:** Otaru University of Commerce
- **2019:** Asian and Australasian Society of Labour Economics 2019 Conference, Asian Development Bank, University of the Philippines, Japanese Association of Development Economics, Otaru University of Commerce, Hitotsubashi University, Japan Economic Association, University of Tokyo
- **2015:** Korea-Japan Inter University Conference

Other

- **Service:** Referee for Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics
- **Software:** Stata, R, Python, Matlab, Fortran, LaTeX
- **Languages:** Japanese (native), English (fluent), and Italian (intermediate)

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